

Fire Districts and Special Use Districts – Water and Wastewater (Sept 2025)

Fire districts are municipal corporations. Their purpose is to manage certain functions of town government that either are not available throughout the entire town, or are better administered by a distinct, special-purpose entity. Fire districts have been formed to manage community sewer systems, sidewalks, street lighting, fire departments, and water systems. DEC has a guidance document with more information on fire districts that are water systems: [How to Form a Fire District](#)

In terms of ARPA funding, fire, water and sewer districts are considered special-purpose units of government because they perform specific functions in the community. They have their own governing bodies and are not part of a city or town's budget. Special-purpose units of local government will not receive funding allocations; however, a state or local government may transfer funds to a special-purpose unit. There is more information here: [Department of Treasury FAQ](#)

Type	Services	Number in Vermont	List of Systems
Fire Districts	Drinking Water Only	64	See below
	Wastewater Only	2	North Branch Fire District 1 (West Dover) Sherburne Fire District 1 (Killington)
	Both Drinking Water and Wastewater	7	Cold Brook Fire District 1 (Wilmington) Lunenburg Fire District 2 (Gilman) Ryegate Fire District 2 Wallingford Fire District 1 Westford Fire District 1 Winhall-Stratton Fire District 1 Worcester Fire District 1
Water Districts	Drinking Water Only	7	Champlain Water District (S Burlington) Derby Line Village Water District Elmore Water District Grand Isle Consolidated Water District Tri Town Water District (Bridport) Vergennes Panton Water District Wilmington Water District
Sewer Districts	Wastewater Only	0	None in Vermont

Draft Analysis of Fire Districts in Vermont

We looked at the 71 fire districts that provide drinking water or both water and wastewater to provide these statistics and examples.

- The number of customers served by these fire districts ranges from 29 to 8300. The average is 588 customers, the median is 212.
- Approximately two-thirds to three-quarters of fire districts are the “primary” water provider for their town or village settlement area.

- In Brandon, the downtown area and most residents are served by Brandon Fire District 1. The town owns the wastewater system, but is not involved in providing drinking water.
- In many smaller towns in the Northeast Kingdom, one or more settlement areas are served by a fire district – such as Greensboro Fire District 1 and Greensboro Bend Fire District 2 or Lunenburg Fire District 1 and Lunenburg Fire District 2 (which serves the unincorporated community of Gilman).
- There are also Fire Districts that provide drinking water to small neighborhoods that aren't served by larger town systems, such as South Burlington Fire District (which serves the Queen City Park neighborhood), Williston Fire District 1 (which serves a manufactured home community), and the several Rutland Town fire districts.

List of Fire Districts Providing Drinking Water

(Alphabetical by town name)

System Name	System Town	Population Served	Services
Alburgh Fire District 1	Alburgh	87	Water
South Alburgh Fire District 2	Alburgh	300	Water
Bakersfield Fire District 1	Bakersfield	446	Water
Barnet Fire District 2	Barnet	205	Water
McIndoe Falls Fire District 3	Barnet	176	Water
Passumpsic Fire District 1	Barnet	140	Water
Graniteville Fire District 4	Barre Town	700	Water
East Berkshire Fire District 1	Berkshire	184	Water
Brandon Fire District 1	Brandon	3963	Water
Burke Fire District 1	Burke	142	Water
East Calais Fire District 1	Calais	200	Water
Canaan Fire District 2	Canaan	350	Water
Canaan Fire District 1	Canaan	970	Water
Castleton Fire District 1	Castleton	1940	Water
Castleton Fire District 3	Castleton	500	Water
Colchester Fire District 2	Colchester	8300	Water
Coventry Fire District 1	Coventry	251	Water
Craftsbury Fire District 2	Craftsbury	420	Water
Danby Mount Tabor Fire District 1	Danby	385	Water
Danville Fire District 1	Danville	500	Water
Dorset Fire District 1	Dorset	530	Water
East Dorset Fire District 1	Dorset	192	Water
Fairfax Fire District 1	Fairfax	80	Water
East Fairfield Fire District 1	Fairfield	184	Water
Fairfield Fire District 2	Fairfield	126	Water
South Georgia Fire District	Georgia	500	Water
Grand Isle Fire District 4	Grand Isle	1078	Water
Greensboro Bend Fire District 2	Greensboro	71	Water

Greensboro Fire District 1	Greensboro	551	Water
East Hardwick Fire District 1	Hardwick	350	Water
Highgate Fire District 1	Highgate	280	Water
Huntington Fire District 1	Huntington	120	Water
Hyde Park Fire District 1	Hyde Park	275	Water
Irasburg Fire District 1	Irasburg	200	Water
Jericho Fire District 1	Jericho	190	Water
Lunenburg Fire District 1	Lunenburg	250	Water
Lunenburg Fire District 2	Lunenburg	400	Water & WW
Lyn Haven Fire District 1	Lyndon	100	Water
East Middlebury Fire District 1	Middlebury	642	Water
Norwich Fire District 1	Norwich	870	Water
Peacham Fire District 1	Peacham	150	Water
Pownal Fire District 2	Pownal	682	Water
Pownal Fire District 3	Pownal	60	Water
Richmond Fire District 1	Richmond	56	Water
Royalton Fire District 1	Royalton	1500	Water
Rutland Town Fire District 5	Rutland Town	110	Water
Rutland Town Fire District 1	Rutland Town	401	Water
Rutland Town Fire District 11	Rutland Town	29	Water
Rutland Town Fire District 4	Rutland Town	136	Water
Rutland Town Fire District 6	Rutland Town	137	Water
Ryegate Fire District 2	Ryegate	131	Water & WW
Sheffield Fire District 1	Sheffield	50	Water
Cuttingsville Fire District	Shrewsbury	108	Water
South Burlington Fire District	South Burlington	250	Water
South Hero Fire District 4	South Hero	760	Water
St George Fire District 1	St George	42	Water
St George Fire District 2	St George	72	Water
St Johnsbury Center Fire District 1	St Johnsbury	370	Water
Stowe Fire District 2 Gold Brook Circle	Stowe	86	Water
Stowe Fire District 4	Stowe	120	Water
Winhall-Stratton Fire District 1	Stratton	6200	Water & WW
Wallingford Fire District 1	Wallingford	956	Water & WW
Washington Fire District	Washington	170	Water
Waterville Fire District 1	Waterville	84	Water
Ascutney Fire District 2	Weathersfield	485	Water
Westfield Fire District 1	Westfield	120	Water
Westford Fire District 1	Westford	50	Water & WW
Wheelock Fire District 1	Wheelock	50	Water
Williston Fire District 1	Williston	212	Water
Cold Brook Fire District 1	Wilmington	700	Water & WW
Worcester Fire District 1	Worcester	350	Water & WW